

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Orientation: Four Rival Responses to Modern Political Order

CENTRAL FOCUS

Orientation: Four Rival Responses to Modern Political Order

- [1] Fascism is essential for the exam candidate as the standard case of a modern totalitarian ideology that rejected both liberal-democracy and Marxism, and as Gauba frames it, a subject of "political pathology" rather than a coherent political philosophy. (PDF pp.64-65)

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- [2] Socialism, anarchism and Gandhism each criticize capitalism/coercion while still valuing liberty or equality in some form; fascism is the outlier that explicitly rejects liberty, equality and reason themselves, so it must never be grouped with the other three as a fellow "egalitarian" doctrine.

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- [3] Socialism broadens the anti-capitalist field beyond Marxism and asks how equality can be secured through public control of production. (PDF pp.55-56)

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- [4] Anarchism forces the exam candidate to distinguish opposition to coercive state authority from mere chaos or disorder. (PDF pp.73-78)

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- [5] Gandhism introduces an Indian ethical-political alternative centred on truth, non-violence, trusteeship and dignity of labour. (PDF pp.78-83)

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SYNTHESIS -> Orientation: Four Rival Responses to Modern Political Order is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

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Socialism: Definitions, Types and Democratic Reform

- [1] He then distinguishes evolutionary socialism from revolutionary socialism: the former compromises with capitalism through democratic reform, while the latter seeks total transformation through revolution. (PDF p.56)

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- [2] Evolutionary / democratic socialism: socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture. (PDF pp.56-57)

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- [3] Socialism: ownership or control of the means of production by the community or public authority in the interest of all. (PDF p.55)

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- [4] Gauba first defines socialism by its aim of public control of major means of production for the public interest. (PDF p.55)

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- [5] He explains fascism as a reaction against democracy, socialism and communism, built on hierarchy over equality, the leader/single-party state over pluralism, myth/faith over reason, and extreme nationalism aiming at homogeneity rather than the liberal ideal of human equality. (PDF pp.66-69)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Fascism: Doctrine, Leader Principle and Totalitarian State

CENTRAL FOCUS

Fascism: Doctrine, Leader Principle and Totalitarian State

- [1] Fascism vs liberalism: fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise. (PDF p.66)

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- [2] Hitler: partially adopted fascism in Nazi Germany, adding a racist doctrine and the "myth of race" alongside Mussolini's nationalist myth; Gauba treats Nazism as fascism's chief variant, not as strictly identical to it. (PDF pp.64, 69)

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- [3] Fascism vs Marxism: fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central. (PDF pp.68-69)

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- [4] Fascism vs socialism/communism: fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses. (PDF p.73)

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- [5] Mussolini: founder of Italian fascism (1919); defined its "myth of the nation" and its rejection of the economic conception of history in his own writings and speeches. (PDF pp.64, 68-69)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Fascism: Social Basis, Critiques and Gauba's Verdict

CENTRAL FOCUS

Fascism: Social Basis, Critiques and Gauba's Verdict

- [1] A safe answer example is to contrast class cooperation through trusteeship, totalitarian hierarchy through fascism, and class conflict through revolution as three rival responses to the same capitalist crisis.
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- [2] Fabianism uses the already existing democratic state as an instrument of reform instead of destroying it first. (PDF pp.57-58)
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- [3] Mussolini's dismantling of Italy's parliamentary parties into "the" party, and his conversion of the premiership into "head of the government," illustrates the leader principle in practice. (PDF p.67)
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- [4] Fascist states brought the press, radio, publishing and cinema under government control and subordinated even the judiciary to fascist ideals, illustrating the totalitarian reach of the leader-led single-party state. (PDF p.68)
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- [5] Proudhon's model imagines producers' associations linked by a federal principle and supported by a mutual credit bank. (PDF p.75)

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Anarchism: Voluntary Order, Thinkers and Internal Strands

- [1] Define anarchism as opposition to coercive state authority, not to all order. (PDF pp.73-74)

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- [2] Sarvodaya is the constructive social-order counterpart to satyagraha's method and trusteeship's economic ethic: satyagraha supplies the method of non-violent resistance/persuasion, trusteeship supplies the economic ethic of stewardship, and Sarvodaya names the resulting social goal – uplift of all, beginning with the weakest.

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- [3] These additions strengthen the socialism/anarchism/Gandhism reconstruction only; the fascism reconstruction in §§2-9 above remains the authoritative, factually disciplined account and is not diluted, expanded with speculative parallels, or re-opened here.

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- [4] Define fascism as an incoherent, leader-led, single-party totalitarian doctrine that rejects liberalism, Marxism and democracy through extreme nationalism, hierarchy and myth. (PDF pp.64-69)

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SYNTHESIS -> Anarchism: Voluntary Order, Thinkers and Internal Strands is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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Gandhism: Satyagraha, Trusteeship, Swaraj and Sarvodaya

- [1] Synthesis verdict: reading the four doctrines along these same four axes shows that fascism alone answers "equality" with hierarchy and "liberty" with subordination to the leader – this is precisely what places it outside the family of anti-capitalist, broadly egalitarian responses, even though socialism, anarchism and Gandhism themselves disagree sharply on how much coercive state power, if any, is legitimate en route to equality.

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- [2] Premises: (a) capitalism generates class inequality and, in some readings, coercive concentration of power – a diagnosis shared by socialism, anarchism and Gandhism (Gaub, PDF pp.55-56, 73-74, 79-83); (b) the doctrines differ on whether the state is the right instrument to fix this – socialism says yes if reformed, anarchism says no and seeks abolition, Gandhism says no and seeks moral transcendence (Gaub, PDF pp.55-83); (c) fascism denies the diagnosis itself, treating hierarchy and leader-rule as desirable rather than as a problem to be solved (Gaub, PDF p.66).

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- [3] Conclusion: an answer that files all "anti-liberal" or "anti-capitalist" doctrines together misses the topic's deepest fault line, which is not liberalism versus its critics but equality-seeking critics (socialism/anarchism/Gandhism) versus hierarchy-seeking fascism (§13 synthesis verdict).

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SYNTHESIS -> Gandhism: Satyagraha, Trusteeship, Swaraj and Sarvodaya is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Four-Doctrine Synthesis, Traps and Answer Architecture

- [1] The Gandhi-Tolstoy influence link (§12.3) and the cross-chapter Sarvodaya citation (§12.4, Gauba PDF pp.489-490, drawn from the common-good chapter rather than this chapter's own PDF pp.55-83 range) are flagged specifically for provenance reasons; do not upgrade them to status or attach a specific letter, date, edition or page number beyond what is already anchored here without independent verification.

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- [2] Fascism factual discipline is unchanged by this update: all fascism content remains confined to §§2-9 above, sourced only from Gauba's own critical framing (PDF pp.64-73), and is not used here as a template for governance design or a source of positive lessons.

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- [3] Primary source used directly: O. P. Gauba, An Introduction to Political Theory, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.55-83, with a cross-chapter Sarvodaya anchor at PDF pp.489-490 (common-good chapter).

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- [4] Tags: #PoliticalTheory #Socialism #Fascism #Totalitarianism #Anarchism #Gandhism #Trusteeship #BreadLabour #Sarvodaya #Fabianism #Syndicalism #Conservatism #Burke #Oakeshott.

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SYNTHESIS -> Four-Doctrine Synthesis, Traps and Answer Architecture is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Conservatism I: Burke, Oakeshott and the Four Pillars

- [1] Relation to Burke: Oakeshott supplies the epistemological argument (why blueprint politics cannot know enough) for what Burke argues historically and prudentially (why blueprint politics destroys the accumulated capital of an order). They are complementary, not identical: Burke defends particular inherited institutions; Oakeshott is more sceptical about all political doctrine, including any doctrine of conservatism itself.

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- [2] Working definition: conservatism is the political doctrine that treats inherited institutions, practices and settled expectations as a store of accumulated practical experience, and therefore places the burden of proof on those proposing to redesign them – favouring gradual, corrective, reversible reform over comprehensive reconstruction from first principles.

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- [3] Genus/differentia line for a "Define" directive: conservatism belongs to the genus of doctrines about the warrant for political change; its differentia is that it locates warrant in inherited practice and demonstrated workability rather than in a rationally designed end-state.

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SYNTHESIS -> Conservatism I: Burke, Oakeshott and the Four Pillars is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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CENTRAL FOCUS

Conservatism II: Strands, Critiques and Comparative Change

- [1] Conclusion: reform should be particular (one defect at a time), evidenced (against the actual working of the institution), reversible (leaving a route back) and continuous with what exists (Oakeshott's intimations) – which is a demanding standard for change, not a veto on it.

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- [2] P1 (epistemic): the knowledge required to run a society is dispersed, largely tacit and carried in practices, not concentrated in any designer's head (Oakeshott's practical/technical distinction, §22.4).

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- [3] P2 (institutional): existing institutions encode solutions to problems whose original occasion has often been forgotten; the reasons for a practice are frequently invisible to the reformer examining it (Burke's prescription, §22.3).

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- [4] P3 (consequential): comprehensive redesign is simultaneous and irreversible – it removes the fallback arrangements that would allow an error to be corrected, so its failures compound rather than self-limit.

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SYNTHESIS -> Conservatism II: Strands, Critiques and Comparative Change is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Conservatism III: Evidence, Indian Caution and Mark-Scaled Answers

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Conservatism III: Evidence, Indian Caution and Mark-Scaled Answers

[1] 15-mark (~200-250 words): (1) thesis; (2) §22.7's premises → mechanism → conclusion spine compressed to three sentences; (3) two evidence units spanning Burke and Oakeshott (C1/C2 + C3); (4) one full objection → reply chain from §22.8 with its residual weakness conceded; (5) verdict distinguishing method-critique from motive-critique.

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[2] The Burke/Oakeshott vocabulary is European in origin and was formulated against particular European events (the French Revolution; mid-20th-century British planning debates). It transfers to Indian material only as an analytical lens, and any Indian factual claim must come independently verified from the History, Social-Justice or Polity files – this Political-Theory file asserts none.

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[3] The most defensible use is structural: the nineteenth-century Indian social-reform debates pose exactly the question this module frames – when an inherited practice is challenged, does its antiquity create a presumption in its favour, and what rebuts that presumption? Use the lens to state the question precisely; do not use it to characterise any named movement, community or party.

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SYNTHESIS -> Conservatism III: Evidence, Indian Caution and Mark-Scaled Answers is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

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MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

- [1] "Conservatism = fascism = reaction.": Reaction seeks to restore a superseded order; conservatism seeks to conserve and repair the existing one; fascism (§§2-9) seeks a leader-centred totalitarian reconstruction that overrides inherited constitutional restraint – which is precisely what a Burkean position exists to defend.

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- [2] Trap: "Gandhi appealed to village tradition, therefore Gandhi is a conservative." -> Gandhi attacks entrenched social hierarchy and subordinates property to trusteeship (Gauba, PDF pp.81-82; §13 Equality and Property rows); appealing to indigenous practice against imported models is not the same as granting inherited hierarchy a presumption of legitimacy.

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- [3] Prudential reform – the decisive point: prescription creates a presumption in favour of what exists, not an immunity. Burke's argument against the French revolutionaries is directed at method and scale – the simultaneous abolition of an entire institutional order on the authority of an abstract theory – while he defends timely, particular, remedial reform that repairs a defect without dismantling the frame that makes repair possible. The exam-usable formula is "reform in order to conserve": change is the instrument of continuity, not its opposite.

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SYNTHESIS -> MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

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PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

[1] Objection -> reply -> residual. Objection: trusteeship depends on the voluntary moral conversion of owners and may simply preserve unequal ownership. Reply: Gandhi treats trusteeship as a non-violent DIRECTION of transition, not a celebration of possession. Residual: without enforceable institutions the objection stands -- Ambedkar's warning against relying on the conscience of the dominant is decisive, and Gandhian socialism needs institutional backing to be more than exhortation.

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[2] PROPERTY: socialism = social control in varied forms (state, cooperative, market, moral); communism = common ownership with classes abolished.

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[3] The doctrine, exactly. Anarchism holds that coercive political authority, paradigmatically the sovereign state, lacks adequate moral justification, and that order can rest on voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. Its engine is the burden-of-justification argument: legitimate authority must respect autonomy and equality (1); the state claims a territorial monopoly of law and coercion (2); it demands obedience for a command's LEGALITY, not its rightness (3); that subordinates my judgment to another's institutional will (4); so the state bears a burden it cannot discharge (5).

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SYNTHESIS -> PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.